SwingScope

30-DAY SHARPENING PLAN

A day-by-day plan to find out whether this model has an edge — using the one form of evidence that cannot be overfitted: forward picks recorded before the outcome is known.

The app will not get sharper from more ideas.
It gets sharper from evidence. Most days in this plan say “do nothing”, and that is deliberate.

~30 minutes per week · 4 longer sessions
Educational and research use only

Read this first

You asked me to accumulate ideas daily and improve the app over 30 days. I can't do that — I have no memory between conversations, and no ability to work while you're away. Every session with me starts blank.

But the honest reframe is better than the original request:

This app will not get sharper from more ideas. It will get sharper from evidence. I could add fifty more features and most would make it worse — more parameters means more ways to fit noise and more false confidence. What actually sharpens it is the one thing only elapsed time can produce: **forward picks, recorded before the outcome is known, then scored.**

That is the entire point of the next 30 days. Not cleverness. Data.

Your total time commitment: about 30 minutes a week, plus four longer sessions. Most days on this plan say "do nothing," and that is deliberate — overtrading and over-tinkering are the two most reliable ways to destroy a trading system.

Week 1 — Establish the truth

The goal this week is to find out whether you have anything at all. Do not skip to trading.

Day 1 (60–90 min) — Baseline validation

1. Deploy the app if you haven't.
2. Open **Validation**. Settings: horizon 15, period 5y, stocks 40, permutations 400, overlapping windows **off**.
3. Run it. Record in a notebook: - Mean IC: **__ - t-statistic: _ - *Permutation p-value: - Quintiles monotonic?*** ___

Decision gate:

Result	What it means	Action
IC ≤ 0	Score doesn't rank returns	**Stop.** Don't paper trade. Go to Day 3.
p > 0.10	Indistinguishable from random	**Stop.** Same as above.
IC 0.02–0.06, p < 0.05	Weak but real	Proceed to Day 2
IC > 0.15	Too good — suspect a bug	Investigate before believing it

Write the number down. Everything in week 4 compares against it.

Day 2 (45 min) — Backtest baseline

Open **Backtest**. Threshold 65, hold 18, check every 5, 30 stocks, regime filter on, costs on. Record: trades, win rate, expectancy, max drawdown, and whether expectancy rises across score buckets.

Then run it again with the regime filter **off**. Does the filter help? Write both down.

Day 3 (30 min) — Sensitivity check

Re-run validation at horizons 10, 15, 20, and 25 days.

What you want to see: IC roughly stable across horizons. **What kills the model:** IC strongly positive at 15 and negative at 20. That means you found a horizon-specific artifact, not a signal.

Day 4 (20 min) — First forward snapshot

1. Run the Screener. Note the regime.
2. Open **Forward log** → Snapshot top 10 picks.
3. **Download the CSV.** Do this every single time.

This is the most important twenty minutes of the month. The clock starts now.

Days 5–7 — Do nothing

Genuinely nothing. No re-running, no tinkering. If you want to be useful, read the manual's glossary and sections 10–13 properly.

Week 2 — Accumulate, don't optimise

Day 8 (20 min) — Snapshot 2

Screener → Forward log → snapshot → download. Note the regime state.

Day 9 (60 min) — Add earnings exclusion

The highest-value code change available, and it needs no new data source.

```
# Add to a new file, earnings.py
import yfinance as yf
import datetime as dt
import streamlit as st

@st.cache_data(ttl=60*60*24, show_spinner=False)
def next_earnings(ticker: str) -> dt.date | None:
    try:
        cal = yf.Ticker(ticker).calendar
        if cal is None:
            return None
        val = cal.get("Earnings Date") if isinstance(cal, dict) else None
        if isinstance(val, list) and val:
            val = val[0]
        return val.date() if hasattr(val, "date") else val
    except Exception:
        return None

def reports_within(ticker: str, days: int = 20) -> bool:
    d = next_earnings(ticker)
    if d is None:
        return False
    return 0 <= (d - dt.date.today()).days <= days
```

Then filter the screener results, or just add an "Earnings soon" warning column. A technical setup with results inside the holding window is a coin flip wearing a costume.

Days 10–14 — Do nothing

Week 3 — First signal, first refinements

Day 15 (30 min) — Snapshot 3 + first evaluation

Snapshot as usual. Then hit **Evaluate** — your Day 4 picks have matured.

You now have your first forward data point. **Ignore what it says.** Ten picks is pure noise. You are looking for the process to work, not the result.

Day 16 (60 min) — Sector concentration guard

Real risk you currently carry: five financials in your top ten isn't five positions, it's one leveraged bet on interest rates. Add a cap of two names per sector to the screener output, using `yf.Ticker(t).info.get("sector")` cached daily.

Day 18 (45 min) — Parameter stability test

Re-run validation with the score threshold at 60, 65, 70, and 75.

Healthy: IC changes gradually. **Fatal:** IC is 0.06 at threshold 65 and 0.01 at 70. That's a knife-edge, which means you found noise. A real edge is robust to small parameter changes.

Days 17, 19–21 — Do nothing

Week 4 — The verdict

Day 22 (20 min) — Snapshot 4 + evaluate

Day 24 (60 min) — Delivery percentage (optional, higher effort)

NSE's bhavcopy carries delivery percentage — the share of volume that resulted in actual delivery rather than intraday churn. Above 50% on an up-move suggests genuine accumulation. It's the best free proxy for "is this real money."

Fragile to scrape; skip it if the earnings and sector work isn't finished.

Day 29 (20 min) — Snapshot 5 + evaluate

Day 30 (90 min) — The reckoning

This is the session everything else was building toward.

1. Open **Forward log**. Evaluate everything mature.
2. Note forward IC and the score-bucket table.
3. Enter your Day 1 backtest IC in the comparison box.
4. Read what it tells you.

How to interpret:

Forward vs backtest IC	Meaning	Action
Forward ≤ 0, backtest > 0	Classic overfitting signature	**Do not trade.** Rebuild or abandon.
Forward < 40% of backtest	Substantial decay	Paper trade 3 more months
Forward 40–80% of backtest	Normal, healthy decay	Consider small live size
Forward > 80% of backtest	Holding up	Still only 5 snapshots — keep going

The honest caveat: five snapshots of ten picks is fifty observations. That is not enough to conclude much. Thirty days tells you whether the *process* works and catches gross overfitting. It does not confirm an edge. Twelve weeks starts to mean something.

What to do on day 31

If forward IC is negative: you just saved yourself real money. Most people discover this with capital instead of a spreadsheet. Either rebuild the score from a different premise, or accept that discretionary chart reading with strict risk management may serve you better than a systematic model.

If forward IC is weakly positive: keep paper trading for another eight weeks before risking anything. Add one improvement at a time and re-measure — never two at once, or you won't know which one mattered.

If forward IC is solidly positive: start live at **quarter size**. Your first live trades should be small enough that being wrong about everything costs you tuition, not capital.

The discipline that makes this work

Change one thing at a time. Two simultaneous changes and you learn nothing about either.

Record before you know. Every snapshot must be committed before the outcome exists. The moment you start filtering picks after the fact, the log becomes worthless.

Don't re-run validation after every tweak. That's how you overfit to your own test set. Set parameters from reasoning, then measure once.

Download the CSV every session. Session state resets. Losing four weeks of forward data because you closed a tab would be genuinely painful.

Expect boredom. Most days here say do nothing. That is the plan working, not the plan failing.

Working with me over these 30 days

Since I don't remember previous sessions, when you come back paste in:

1. The numbers you recorded (validation IC, backtest expectancy, forward IC)
2. Your current forward log CSV
3. What you changed since last time

With that I can pick up properly — analyse the results, debug what broke, implement the next enhancement. What I can't do is remember it myself.

Educational and research use only. Not investment advice. The plan above is a research methodology, not a recommendation to trade. Consider consulting a SEBI-registered adviser.